25901535 – Answer key

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM
MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION March 2026
Fourth SEMESTER
Discipline Specific Elective (DSE) - MG4DSESOC200 - CRIME AND SOCIETY
(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 1 hour 30 minutes **Maximum Marks: 50**

Part A – Short Answer

1. Criminals are not treated equally because factors like class, caste, and power influence how laws are enforced.
2. Society influences crime through social norms, inequalities, and differential access to opportunities.
3. Domestic violence refers to physical, emotional, or psychological abuse within family or intimate relationships.
4. Probation is a non-custodial punishment allowing offenders to remain in society under supervision.
5. Criminology is important as it studies causes, prevention, and control of criminal behaviour.
6. Becker argued that deviance is defined through social reactions and labeling by society.
7. Evolutionary theory views crime as adaptive behaviour linked to survival and competition.
8. Online harassment includes cyberbullying, stalking, trolling, and digital abuse.
9. Sutherland meant that criminal behaviour is learned through exposure to definitions favourable to law violation.
10. Evolutionary theories link aggression and risk-taking to survival instincts and reproductive success.
11. Over-compensation may lead juveniles to delinquency as they attempt to assert identity or overcome inferiority.
12. Merton’s strain theory states that blocked access to goals leads individuals to deviance.
13. Legal remedy refers to means provided by law to enforce rights or seek justice.
14. Psychological causes such as trauma, frustration, or personality disorders may lead to crime.
15. Biological causes include genetic predisposition and neurological or hormonal influences.
16. Neighbourhood conditions like poverty and social disorganization can increase criminal tendencies.

Part B – Short Essay

17a. Beccaria’s hedonistic theory suggests individuals act based on pleasure–pain calculations. He argued punishment should be certain, swift, and proportionate to deter crime.

17b. Physical abuse against children causes severe physical and emotional harm. It often leads to long-term psychological trauma and behavioural issues.

18a. Rehabilitation aims to reform offenders into socially responsible individuals. It focuses on reintegration through education, therapy, and skill development.

18b. Structural inequality creates deprivation and marginalisation in society. This may push disadvantaged individuals towards crime as an alternative means.

19a. Psychogenic theories link early childhood trauma to later criminal behaviour. Emotional disturbances shape deviant personality patterns over time.

19b. Sexual violence results in severe psychological trauma and social stigma. It reinforces gender inequality and restricts women's social participation.

20a. Crimes are classified into crimes against individuals, property, and the state. This classification helps in legal categorisation and administration of justice.

20b. Crime prevention aims to reduce opportunities for crime, while correction focuses on reforming offenders. Both are complementary strategies for maintaining social order.